

many in number. These include remote controls, infrared data transfer devices, radio identification devices and some others. There now follows a brief description of these technologies.

7.1 Remote control

A remote control is a small device that is used to control another device from a distance. Remote controls are now standard accompaniments to various household devices such as televisions, stereo systems and air conditioners. Today, remote controls are usually small, easy-to-handle, handheld devices that possess many buttons which help control the functions performed by these household devices. In fact, nowadays, the remote control is the primary control and it contains all the function controls. The device that is being controlled, on the other hand, usually has only a handful of rudimentary controls on it.

The remote control traces its history as far back as 1898, when Nikola Tesla patented a device, named 'Method of an Apparatus for Controlling Mechanism of Moving Vehicle or Vehicles'. In 1903, Leonardo Torres Quevedo invented a device called the Telekino. The telekino was essentially a robot. This robot executed commands that were given to it by the means of electromagnetic waves. The first remote controlled airplane flew in 1932. As a result of this technology, remote control technology was extensively employed in the Second World War. The first remote control for televisions, called "Lazy bones", was developed by Zenith Radio Corporation in 1950. The impetus to make remotes that would perform several functions began in the late 1970s due to BBC's development of the Ceefax teletext service.

Today, most of the remote controls available are consumer



11 different remote controls kept side by side